# 2009 Toyota Camry LE (115k mi)

$5,800 · 115,000 miles · Private seller · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Craigslist

Listing: https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/bakersfield-2009-toyota-camry-le/nyUZCqxCxyJwbyY15f4BTM

Report generated October 31, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder










+ 2 more photos in the app.

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$6,562** | **$467** | **Good** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 4/5 · 10 recalls · 1,412 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $5,800.00 |
| Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV | $536.50 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $37.70 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $65.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $6,562.20 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $1,562.20 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $31.30 |
| Total interest over the loan | $316.00 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $31.30 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $135.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 25 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $190.00 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $95.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $15.64 |
| Total per month | $466.94 |

Running costs without the loan: **$436/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$12,048** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Good (4/5)**

Good overall, with the same caveat as the Ridgecrest Camry: the 2007-2009 2.4L can burn oil, and dashboards get sticky in desert heat. Lower miles than the local one.

NHTSA data for this model year: 10 recalls · 1,412 owner complaints (160 involving a crash). Most complaints: Vehicle Speed Control (285), Structure (241), Engine (219), Unknown Or Other (183), Service Brakes (166), Visibility/Wiper (100).

**Known issues for this model**

• 2.4L (2AZ-FE) oil consumption (2007-2009)

• Sticky/melting dashboard in heat

• Water pump leaks

• Recalls: accelerator pedal/floor mat, power-window switch

**Check on this car before buying**

• Check oil level / blue smoke at startup

• Seller provides the smog certificate

• Inspect the dashboard

• Run VIN for open recalls (free at Toyota dealers)

## Notes

$5,800, 115k mi, 4-cylinder, automatic. Clean title, tags until June 2027, 'smog check ready'. Condition listed 'like new'.

Compare: the Ridgecrest 2009 Camry is $5,000 with 148k mi - this one has 33k fewer miles for $800 more.

~2 hr drive from Ridgecrest (CA-178). Confirm availability and get an out-the-door price by phone/text before driving.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.